STRATIVA CONSULTING

BUSINESS CONTINUITY & INCIDENT RESPONSE PLAN

Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.

Operational Resilience & Risk Management Manual

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CONFIDENTIAL & PROPRIETARY — STRATIVA CONSULTING HEADQUARTERS

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1. COMPANY INFORMATION & DOCUMENT CONTROL

Strativa Consulting is a business consulting, strategy development, project management, market research, branding, marketing, digital marketing, financial planning, and website/technology support startup based in Karachi, Pakistan. This Business Continuity and Incident Response Plan (Document Reference: **STR-BC-IR-013**) establishes structured operational resilience protocols to safeguard employees, protect confidential client records, and maintain critical service delivery during unexpected disruptions.

Company Name	Strativa Consulting	**Tagline**	Smart Strategies. Sustainable Growth.
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2. PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES

This plan helps Strativa Consulting prepare for unexpected events, protect important information, maintain essential services, communicate responsibly, and restore normal business operations. The primary objectives are to:

- Protect employees and other affected individuals from harm.
- Reduce interruptions to essential business activities and client commitments.
- Protect client information and confidential company records from loss or exposure.
- Maintain transparent, professional communication with clients and team members.
- Recover important files, digital systems, and workflows efficiently.
- Establish clear incident responsibilities and structured escalation procedures.
- Learn from incidents and implement corrective actions to reduce recurrence.

> **ACADEMIC & HYPOTHETICAL DISCLAIMER**
> This document is prepared as a comprehensive operational resilience blueprint for a hypothetical consulting startup in Karachi for academic final project submission. All scenarios, risk ratings, recovery targets, and schedules represent proposed internal policies subject to review and adaptation by management as the startup scales. Hypothetical client references (such as the boutique fashion brand AZ Signature) are utilized strictly as illustrative operational examples.

3. SCOPE AND ASSUMPTIONS

This plan covers the primary operational activities of Strativa Consulting, including client communication, project planning and delivery, consulting and research work, marketing and content production, brand design, financial modeling, website/technology support, and company recordkeeping. As a service-based business rather than a manufacturer, focus is placed on digital resources, office equipment, personnel, client relationships, and essential business workflows.

Planning Assumptions: The company operates with a lean startup model in Karachi, relying on cloud repositories (Google Cloud Enterprise Drive), Microsoft 365 productivity tools, local workstations, and high-speed internet connections. It does not maintain dedicated physical servers, multiple offices, or expensive enterprise disaster recovery infrastructure. All recovery targets and schedules are proposed planning assumptions rather than guaranteed commitments.

4. BUSINESS IMPACT ANALYSIS AND RECOVERY PRIORITIES

Essential business activities are categorized across three priority levels:

- **Priority 1 — Critical:** Activities requiring immediate attention (client communication, active project document access, critical deadlines).
- **Priority 2 — High:** Activities restored immediately after critical functions (ongoing research, marketing drafts, administrative records).
- **Priority 3 — Normal:** Activities that can be temporarily delayed without harming client trust (routine internal meetings, archival filing).

4.1 Business Impact Analysis (BIA) Register

Business Activity	Impact if Interrupted	Priority	Max Acceptable Downtime (Proposed)	Recovery Action	Responsible Role
Client Inquiries & Communication	Loss of client trust; delayed project onboarding.	Priority 1	2 Hours	Switch to mobile/backup email channels.	Client Relationship Manager
Active Project Delivery	Missed milestones; contractual breach risk.	Priority 1	4 Hours	Access cloud backup files; reassign tasks.	Project Manager
Cloud File Repository Access	Inability for team to collaborate on deliverables.	Priority 1	4 Hours	Restore from secondary encrypted cloud backup.	Web & Tech Specialist
Financial & Administrative Records	Inability to process invoices or payroll.	Priority 2	24 Hours	Restore local accounting backups.	Financial Consultant / PM
Marketing & Social Publishing	Temporary pause in brand awareness campaigns.	Priority 3	48 Hours	Reschedule content calendar post-recovery.	Digital Marketing Specialist

5. INCIDENT TYPES AND RISK ASSESSMENT

The following risk register evaluates potential operational disruptions for Strativa Consulting:

Incident / Risk	Possible Cause	Potential Impact	Likelihood	Impact	Priority	Preventive Controls	Response Owner
1. Internet Outage	ISP fiber cut; local grid failure.	Inability to communicate or access cloud files.	High	Medium	High	Mobile data hotspots; backup 4G router.	Web & Tech Specialist
2. Electricity Outage	K-Electric load shedding; grid fault.	Workstation shutdown; loss of active work.	High	Medium	High	UPS battery backups; laptop power reserves.	All Personnel
3. File Deletion / Loss	Accidental user deletion; sync error.	Loss of active project drafts.	Medium	High	High	Cloud version history; automated backups.	Project Manager
4. Malware / Ransomware	Phishing email; malicious download.	System lock; data encryption.	Low	High	Critical	Antivirus software; employee security training.	Web & Tech Specialist
5. Account Compromise	Weak password; credential theft.	Unauthorized access to client data.	Low	Critical	Critical	Multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all accounts.	Web & Tech Specialist
6. Key Staff Absence	Sudden illness; family emergency.	Project delay on specialized tasks.	Medium	Medium	Medium	Cross-training; shared cloud file access.	Project Manager
7. Website / Tech Outage	Hosting server downtime; DNS failure.	Inaccessible corporate website.	Low	Medium	Medium	Reliable hosting provider; status monitoring.	Web & Tech Specialist
8. Office Disruption	Building maintenance; local emergency.	Inability to access physical office.	Low	Medium	Medium	Full remote work capability via cloud tools.	Managing Director

6. INCIDENT RESPONSE STRUCTURE AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Incident response is executed across Strativa Consulting's existing 11 roles. While multiple roles may be assigned to available individuals during an emergency, every incident must have a clear response coordinator.

- **Managing Director / Founder:** Executive authority for major business continuity decisions, legal/financial risk handling, and approval of external communications.
- **Project Manager:** Coordinates routine incident response, operational recovery, task re-assignment, and incident logging.
- **Web and Technology Specialist:** Leads technical assessment and recovery of digital tools, accounts, backups, and IT infrastructure.
- **Client Relationship Manager:** Manages approved client communications, updates client contact lists, and tracks delivery expectations.
- **All Other Specialists:** Report incidents promptly, protect files, follow recovery instructions, and avoid unauthorized public statements.

6.1 Incident Response Responsibility Matrix

Incident Category	Lead Role	Supporting Roles	Approval Authority	Notified Role
IT / Technical Outage	Web & Tech Specialist	Project Manager	Project Manager	Managing Director
Data Loss / Backup Failure	Web & Tech Specialist	Project Manager & Task Owner	Managing Director	Managing Director
Cybersecurity / Breach	Web & Tech Specialist	Managing Director	Managing Director	Managing Director & Legal Lead
Client Service Disruption	Client Relationship Manager	Project Manager	Managing Director	Managing Director
Staff Shortage / Absence	Project Manager	Department Leads	Project Manager	Managing Director

7. INCIDENT CLASSIFICATION AND ESCALATION

Incidents are classified into three severity levels to determine appropriate response protocols:

- **Level 1 — Minor:** Limited disruption affecting single device or non-critical task; no impact on client deadlines. Handled locally by task owner; reported in daily logs.
- **Level 2 — Significant:** Disruption affecting multiple employees, an active project, or a project deadline requiring adjustment. Coordinated by Project Manager; MD notified.
- **Level 3 — Critical:** Serious data breach, ransomware infection, loss of critical records, prolonged major outage, or physical emergency threatening business continuity. Coordinated by Managing Director with technical and professional support.

8. STANDARD INCIDENT RESPONSE PROCEDURE

All incidents follow a disciplined 14-step lifecycle. Safety, containment, and accurate communication take priority over quickly restarting compromised systems:

1. **Identify & Protect:** Detect incident and ensure personnel safety from immediate physical danger.
2. **Report:** Report incident immediately through available communication channels.
3. **Log:** Record time, symptoms, affected systems, and reporter details in Incident Register.
4. **Classify:** Assess severity level and identify affected business activities.
5. **Assign Coordinator:** Designate incident response owner according to responsibility matrix.
6. **Contain:** Isolate affected devices or accounts to prevent further damage or spread.
7. **Preserve Evidence:** Protect confidential information and preserve relevant system logs safely.
8. **Notify Internal Team:** Inform management and affected staff members.
9. **Evaluate External Notification:** Determine if clients or authorities must be informed.
10. **Select Workaround:** Establish safe temporary workarounds to maintain essential workflows.
11. **Restore:** Restore systems, files, or workflows from authorized backups.
12. **Verify:** Test restored services to ensure data integrity and reliability.
13. **Confirm Recovery:** Notify stakeholders that normal operations have resumed.
14. **Review & Learn:** Complete post-incident report, record lessons learned, and update preventive controls.

9. IT OUTAGE AND TECHNICAL FAILURE RESPONSE

Specific response procedures govern common technical disruptions:

- **Internet or Network Outage:** Confirm scope (single device vs. office-wide). Switch to approved 4G mobile data hotspots. Notify Project Manager if active project deadlines are affected. Record outage duration.
- **Electricity Outage:** Ensure safety. Save active work immediately if UPS power allows; perform safe shutdown. Utilize laptop battery reserves or relocate to a powered location if necessary. Record schedule impacts.
- **Computer or Equipment Failure:** Stop using damaged hardware immediately. Notify Web & Tech Specialist. Utilize authorized backup workstations or cloud access from another device. Avoid unauthorized hardware repairs.
- **Website, Email, or Software Outage:** Check official provider status pages (Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, hosting provider). Utilize backup communication channels (mobile messaging, alternative email). Notify clients if delivery commitments are affected.

9.1 Technical Incident Escalation Table

Technical Disruption	Immediate Action	Responsible Role	Escalation Threshold
Local Internet Down (<1 hour)	Switch to mobile hotspot.	Affected Employee	None (Routine)
Internet Down (>2 hours)	Relocate or use secondary backup router.	Web & Tech Specialist	Escalate to PM if deadline affected.
Google Workspace Outage	Check Google status; use local cached files.	Web & Tech Specialist	Escalate to MD if outage exceeds 4 hours.
Hardware Failure (Laptop)	Transition to backup device / cloud login.	Web & Tech Specialist	Escalate to MD for hardware replacement.

10. DATA LOSS, BACKUP, AND RECOVERY PROCEDURES

Data protection is maintained through authorized cloud repositories (Google Cloud Enterprise Drive), strict access controls, multi-factor authentication (MFA), and automated version history. Employees are strictly prohibited from storing unencrypted client data on personal unapproved drives.

10.1 Recovery Objectives (Planning Targets)

- **Recovery Point Objective (RPO):** Maximum acceptable data loss duration. Target: $\le 4 ext{ hours}$ for active project files.
- **Recovery Time Objective (RTO):** Target time to restore system or file access. Target: $\le 4 ext{ hours}$ for cloud repositories.

10.2 Data Loss Recovery Steps

1. Stop all activities that may overwrite missing files or corrupt storage.
2. Notify Web & Tech Specialist and Project Manager immediately.
3. Identify exact scope of lost data (specific document, folder, or account).
4. Check automated version history and trash repositories in Google Cloud.
5. Verify integrity of secondary backup source.
6. Execute restoration using authorized recovery protocols.
7. Verify file completeness, formatting, and formula accuracy.
8. Confirm proper user access permissions on restored folders.
9. Inform affected project stakeholders of successful recovery.
10. Record incident cause and implement preventive measures in CAPA register.

11. SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE

Security incidents (phishing, unauthorized access, malware alerts, lost devices, accidental data disclosure) require immediate defensive action:

- Report suspected incidents immediately to Web & Tech Specialist and Managing Director.
- Use a secure, trusted device and approved communication channel if primary accounts are compromised.
- Revoke compromised user sessions and reset credentials through administrator controls.
- Preserve relevant system logs and evidence without altering data.
- Do not delete evidence, pay attackers, or issue unapproved public statements.
- Seek qualified legal, cybersecurity, or regulatory advice when managing sensitive data breaches under applicable privacy requirements.

12. UNEXPECTED EMPLOYEE ABSENCE AND STAFF SHORTAGE

Sudden staff absences are managed through structured continuity protocols to prevent client deliverable delays:

1. Employee or notifier contacts Project Manager via approved channels as early as possible.
2. Project Manager reviews active tasks, pending deadlines, and shared cloud handover notes.
3. Project Manager reassigns urgent tasks temporarily to qualified secondary specialists based on skills and workload availability.
4. Temporary task owner accesses necessary files strictly through authorized company accounts and permissions.
5. Client Relationship Manager informs clients if a scheduled deliverable or meeting requires rescheduling.
6. Upon return, the employee receives a formal handover briefing and resumes pending duties.

12.1 Temporary Task Reassignment Template

Task Description	Original Owner	Temporary Owner	Deadline	Access Required	Status
Retail Strategy Draft	[Staff A]	[Staff B]	22 Oct 2026	Google Cloud Folder #4	Active

13. CLIENT SERVICE INTERRUPTION & EMERGENCY COMMUNICATION

During disruptions, client communications must remain calm, professional, and transparent without revealing unnecessary technical details:

SAMPLE CLIENT SERVICE INTERRUPTION NOTICE

"Dear [Client Name], we are currently experiencing a temporary technical maintenance issue affecting our Karachi operations. Please be assured that your project data remains secure. Our team is actively working on restoration, and we will provide an updated status report by [Time]. Thank you for your patience. Sincerely, Strativa Consulting Client Support."

14. EMERGENCY COMMUNICATION TREE & CONTACT DIRECTORY

Emergency communications follow a strict hierarchical escalation flow:

Person Discovering Incident → Project Manager / Incident Coordinator → Managing Director (for Significant/Critical Issues) → Technical Support / Legal Adviser → Affected Clients & Staff

14.1 Emergency Contact Directory Template

Role / Organization	Primary Contact Method	Alternative Contact
Managing Director / Founder	[Phone / WhatsApp]	[Corporate Email]
Project Manager	[Phone / WhatsApp]	[Corporate Email]
Web & Technology Specialist	[Phone / WhatsApp]	[Corporate Email]
Client Relationship Manager	[Phone / WhatsApp]	[Corporate Email]
External IT Support Provider	[Placeholder Phone]	[Placeholder Email]
Internet / Cloud Provider Support	[Placeholder Support Line]	[Portal Link]

15. BUSINESS CONTINUITY WORKAROUNDS

Temporary operational workarounds maintain productivity during disruptions:

- **Loss of Internet:** Utilize 4G mobile hotspots; download active files locally with mandatory post-restoration cloud sync.
- **Loss of Main Computer:** Access Google Cloud Enterprise Drive and Microsoft 365 from an authorized backup laptop using multi-factor authentication.
- **Absence of Project Manager:** Managing Director assumes temporary operational coordination.
- **Software Tool Outage:** Switch to approved backup productivity applications or offline templates until cloud services resume.

16. RECOVERY AND RETURN TO NORMAL OPERATIONS

Returning to normal business operations follows a structured 10-step verification protocol:

1. Confirm with technical leads that the immediate threat or outage cause is fully controlled.
2. Identify essential services and data repositories that must be brought online first (Priority 1).
3. Restore systems, project records, and communication channels in priority order.
4. Execute technical tests to verify data integrity, file formatting, and system functionality.
5. Confirm authorized user access permissions across restored folders.
6. Review outstanding project deadlines and adjust delivery schedules with management approval.
7. Reassign pending tasks to original owners and close temporary workarounds.
8. Notify clients and staff that normal business operations have successfully resumed.
9. Monitor restored systems closely for 48 hours to detect any recurring anomalies.
10. Complete the Incident Report and conduct a post-incident lessons-learned review.

17. INCIDENT DOCUMENTATION AND REPORTING

Every disruption must be formally logged in the centralized Incident Register. Reports must distinguish verified facts from preliminary observations and include root cause analysis, resolution times, and preventive action assignments.

17.1 Incident Register Template

Incident ID	Date / Time	Type	Severity	Affected Systems	Coordinator	Status / Resolution
INC-2026-01	[Date]	Internet Outage	Level 2	Karachi Office Net	Web Specialist	Resolved (Hotspot switch)

18. TESTING, TRAINING, AND PLAN MAINTENANCE

Operational resilience is maintained through regular testing and staff awareness training (proposed schedule):

- **Staff Awareness Briefings:** Quarterly orientation for all team members on incident reporting and security hygiene.
- **Backup Restoration Tests:** Semi-annual testing of cloud file restoration and data integrity checks.
- **Contact Directory Audits:** Quarterly verification of emergency contact numbers and communication channels.
- **Tabletop Exercises:** Annual simulation of a critical outage scenario (e.g., internet failure during a major client deadline).
- **Plan Review:** Annual review by management or immediately following any major Level 3 incident.

19. BUSINESS CONTINUITY KPIS

Business continuity performance is evaluated using standardized quantitative metrics:

Continuity KPI Name	Calculation Formula	Target Benchmark
Incident Response Time	$ ext{Time Timestamp Reported} - ext{Timestamp Acknowledged}$	$\le 30 ext{ minutes}$
Service Restoration Time	$ ext{Time Normal Operations Resumed} - ext{Incident Detection}$	Within BIA Target Limits
Backup Test Success Rate	$(ext{Successful Restorations} \div ext{Total Tests Conducted}) imes 100$	100%
Unresolved Critical Incidents	$\sum ext{Open Level 3 Incidents Past 24 Hours}$	0
Staff Training Compliance	$(ext{Staff Completed Briefing} \div ext{Total Active Personnel}) imes 100$	100%

20. APPENDICES AND READY-TO-USE TEMPLATES (A–L)

Appendix A: Incident Report Form

INCIDENT REPORT FORM (FORM STR-INC-01)

Incident ID: INC-2026-____ **Date/Time Detected:** _____ **Reported By:** _____

Incident Type: [ ] IT Outage [ ] Data Loss [ ] Security Breach [ ] Staff Absence

Severity Level: [ ] Level 1 (Minor) [ ] Level 2 (Significant) [ ] Level 3 (Critical)

Description of Disruption & Systems Affected: _____

Immediate Action Taken: _____ **Coordinator Assigned:** _____

Appendix B: Incident Register

(Refer to Section 17.1 for the complete Incident Register template).

Appendix C: Business Impact Analysis Table

(Refer to Section 4.1 for the complete BIA table).

Appendix D: Risk Assessment Register

(Refer to Section 5 for the complete Risk Register table).

Appendix E: Emergency Contact Directory

(Refer to Section 14.1 for the Contact Directory template).

Appendix F: Internal Incident Notification Template

INTERNAL INCIDENT NOTIFICATION

"Attention Strativa Team: Please be advised that an operational incident [INC-2026-XX] involving [System/Disruption] has been identified at [Time]. The response team is actively managing recovery. Affected personnel should follow temporary workarounds outlined in the BC/IR plan. Further updates will be provided by [Time]. — Project Manager"

Appendix G: Client Service Interruption Message Template

(Refer to Section 13 for the Client Service Interruption Notice template).

Appendix H: Data Recovery Checklist

DATA RECOVERY CHECKLIST (FORM STR-REC-01)

[ ] 1. Isolate affected storage and halt overwrite activities.
[ ] 2. Notify Web & Tech Specialist and Project Manager.
[ ] 3. Access automated version history or verified cloud backup.
[ ] 4. Execute data restoration into secure sandbox environment.
[ ] 5. Verify file completeness, structure, and formula accuracy.
[ ] 6. Confirm user permissions and notify project stakeholders.

Appendix I: Temporary Staff Reassignment Form

(Refer to Section 12.1 for the Temporary Task Reassignment template).

Appendix J: Recovery and Return-to-Normal Checklist

RETURN-TO-NORMAL CHECKLIST (FORM STR-RET-01)

[ ] 1. Threat or outage cause verified as fully controlled.
[ ] 2. Priority 1 services and repositories fully restored.
[ ] 3. Technical integrity and access permissions verified.
[ ] 4. Project deadlines adjusted and tasks reassigned.
[ ] 5. Clients and staff notified; incident report completed.

Appendix K: Post-Incident Review and Lessons-Learned Form

POST-INCIDENT REVIEW (FORM STR-PIR-01)

Incident ID: _____ **Review Date:** _____ **Lead Reviewer:** _____
Root Cause Analysis: _____
What Went Well in Response: _____
Preventive Actions / SOP Updates Required: _____

Appendix L: Business Continuity Test Record

BUSINESS CONTINUITY TEST RECORD (FORM STR-TST-01)

Test Type: [ ] Backup Restoration [ ] Tabletop Simulation [ ] Contact Audit
Test Date: _____ **Conducted By:** _____ **Result:** [Pass / Fail]
Observations & Action Items: _____